

1 **HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES - FLOOR VERSION**

2 STATE OF OKLAHOMA

3 2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

4 COMMITTEE SUBSTITUTE
5 FOR ENGROSSED
6 SENATE BILL NO. 1894

By: Reinhardt of the Senate

and

West (Tammy) of the House

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11 COMMITTEE SUBSTITUTE

12 An Act relating to teachers; amending 70 O.S. 2021,
13 Section 6-194, as last amended by Section 1, Chapter
14 277, O.S.L. 2025 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 6-194),
15 which relates to professional development programs;
16 changing maximum number of professional development
17 hours from one hundred fifty to two hundred during
18 any five-year period for classroom teachers with less
19 than five years of teaching experience; providing an
20 effective date; and declaring an emergency.

21 BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

22 SECTION 1. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 6-194, as
23 last amended by Section 5, Chapter 101, O.S.L. 2025 (70 O.S. Supp.
24 2025, Section 6-194), is amended to read as follows:

1 Section 6-194. A. The district boards of education of this
2 state shall establish professional development programs for the
3 certified teachers and administrators of the district. Programs
4 shall be adopted by each board based upon recommendations of a
5 professional development committee appointed by the board of
6 education for the district.

7 B. Each professional development committee shall include
8 classroom teachers, administrators, school counselors or licensed
9 mental health providers, and parents, guardians, or custodians of
10 children in the school district and shall consult with a higher
11 education faculty. A majority of the members of the professional
12 development committee shall be composed of classroom teachers. The
13 teacher members shall be selected by a designated administrator of
14 the school district from a list of names submitted by the teachers
15 in the school district. The members selected shall be subject to
16 the approval of a majority vote of the teachers in the district.

17 C. In developing program recommendations, each professional
18 development committee shall annually utilize a data-driven approach
19 to analyze student data and determine district and school
20 professional development needs. The professional development
21 programs adopted shall be directed toward development of
22 competencies and instructional strategies in the core curriculum
23 areas for the following goals:
24

- 1 1. Increasing the academic performance data scores for the
- 2 district and each school site;
- 3 2. Closing achievement gaps among student subgroups;
- 4 3. Increasing student achievement as demonstrated on state-
- 5 mandated tests and the ACT;
- 6 4. Increasing high school graduation rates; and
- 7 5. Decreasing college remediation rates.

8 Each program may also include components on classroom management
9 and student discipline strategies, outreach to parents, guardians,
10 or custodians of students, special education, and racial and ethnic
11 education, which all personnel defined as teachers in Section 1-116
12 of this title shall be required to complete at a frequency as
13 determined by the board of education. The State Board of Education
14 shall provide guidelines to assist school districts in developing
15 and implementing racial and ethnic education components into
16 professional development programs.

17 D. A program which includes the following information shall be
18 completed the first year a certified teacher is employed by a school
19 district, and then once every fifth academic year:

- 20 1. Training on recognition of child abuse and neglect;
- 21 2. Recognition of child sexual abuse;
- 22 3. Proper reporting of suspected abuse including the reporting
- 23 requirements of Section 1-2-101 of Title 10A of the Oklahoma
- 24

1 Statutes and Section 1210.163 of this title and associated penalties
2 for failure to report; and

3 4. Available resources.

4 E. One time per year, beginning in the 2009-2010 school year,
5 training in the area of autism shall be offered and all resident
6 teachers of students in early childhood programs through grade three
7 shall be required to complete the autism training during the
8 resident year and at least one time every three (3) years
9 thereafter. All other teachers and education support professionals
10 of students in early childhood programs through grade three shall be
11 required to complete the autism training at least one time every
12 three (3) years. The autism training shall include a minimum
13 awareness of the characteristics of autistic children, resources
14 available and an introduction to positive behavior supports to
15 challenging behavior. Each adopted program shall allow school
16 counselors to receive at least one-third (1/3) of the hours or
17 credit required each year through programs or courses specifically
18 designed for school counselors.

19 Districts are authorized to utilize any means for professional
20 development that is not prohibited by law including, but not limited
21 to, professional development provided by the district, any state
22 agency, institution of higher education, or any private entity.

23 F. One time per year, beginning in the 2020-2021 school year, a
24 dyslexia awareness program shall be offered. Beginning in the 2023-

2024 school year, the program shall include information and training in dysgraphia. At a minimum, the program shall include:

1. Training in awareness of dyslexia characteristics in students;

2. Training in effective classroom instruction to meet the needs of students with dyslexia; and

3. Available dyslexia resources for teachers, students and parents.

G. Except as otherwise provided for in this subsection, each certified teacher in this state shall be required by the district board of education to meet the professional development requirements established by the board, or established through the negotiation process. Except as otherwise provided for in this subsection, the professional development requirements established by each board of education shall require every teacher to annually complete a minimum number of the total number of points required to maintain employment; provided, no more than a total of ~~one hundred fifty~~ two hundred (200) hours of local, state, or federal professional development or training shall be required for classroom teachers with less than five (5) years of experience as a full-time classroom teacher in the preceding ten (10) years during any five-year period and no more than a total of one hundred fifty (150) hours of local, state, or federal professional development or training shall be required for all other classroom teachers during

1 any five-year period. Failure of any teacher to meet district board
2 of education professional development requirements may be grounds
3 for nonrenewal of such teacher's contract by the board. Such
4 failure may also be grounds for nonconsideration of salary
5 increments affecting the teacher. Teachers shall maintain written
6 documentation of all their completed professional development.

7 H. Each district shall annually submit a report to the State
8 Department of Education on the district level professional
9 development needs, activities completed, expenditures, and results
10 achieved for each school year by each goal as provided in subsection
11 C of this section. If a school district elects not to adopt and
12 offer a professional development program as provided for in
13 subsection A of this section, the district shall not be required to
14 submit an annual report as required pursuant to this subsection but
15 shall report to the State Department of Education its election not
16 to offer a program and all professional development activities
17 completed by teachers and administrators of the school district.

18 I. Subject to the availability of funds, the Department shall
19 develop an online system for reporting as required in subsection H
20 of this section. The Department shall also make such information
21 available on its website.

22 SECTION 2. This act shall become effective July 1, 2026.

23 SECTION 3. It being immediately necessary for the preservation
24 of the public peace, health, or safety, an emergency is hereby

1 declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and
2 be in full force from and after its passage and approval.
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4 COMMITTEE REPORT BY: COMMITTEE ON EDUCATION OVERSIGHT, dated
5 04/14/2026 - DO PASS, As Amended.
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